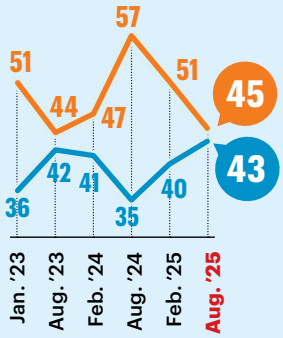
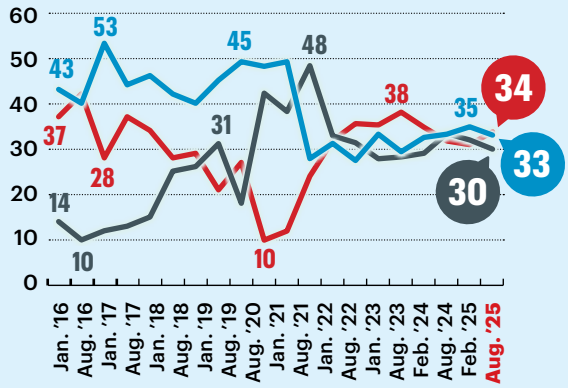
Q. Who, in your opinion, has better managed the overall Indian economy?



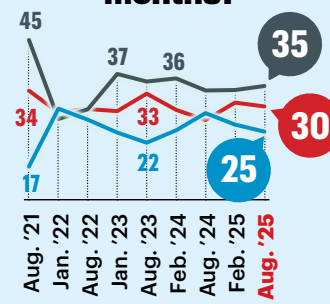
Modi's earlier lead has narrowed sharply, showing public resentment over economic handling

Q. How has your economic status changed since the NDA government came to power in 2014?



One in three respondents reports a decline in their economic condition since the NDA took office in 2014

Q. Is your household income/ salary likely to improve in the next six months?



More than one-third expect their incomes to stagnate; 30 per cent fear a decline

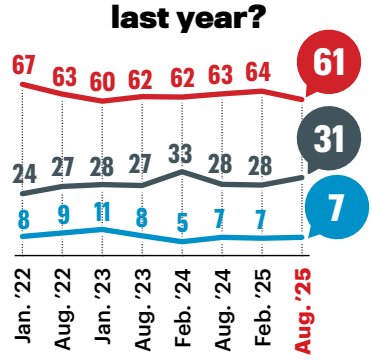
whether being the fourth-largest economy marks a meaningful milestone or a merely symbolic one, nearly half of respondents—49.5 per cent—dismissed it as little more than a headline, with no real impact on everyday life.

There is also a pervasive sense that India's economic growth has failed to trickle down. Only 26.3 per cent believe the benefits are 'widely' shared, while 42.5 per cent say that the gains have accrued solely to the rich. Another 19.6 per cent contend that the middle class alone has prospered. Since the pandemic, economic inequality has sharpened, producing a textbook K-shaped recovery—where the rich pull ahead and the poor fall further behind—a trend the current poll clearly reflects.

The Modi government has bet big on infrastructure, earmarking Rs 11.2 lakh crore for roads, bridges and railways in FY26. Though much remains to be done in linking rural areas with urban centres, the progress is perceptually salient: 58.5 per cent of respondents feel India's global economic image is beginning to reflect in the quality of infrastructure and public services in their regions. Yet, 32.3 per cent see a yawning gap between the international image that India projects and the everyday realities on the ground.

The perception that India's economic policies chiefly serve the rich and powerful persists. A majority—55.8 per cent—now say the Modi government favours big business, up from 51.2 per cent in the previous poll. By contrast, just 9.8 per cent and 8 per cent believe farmers and small enterprises have benefited, respectively. Nearly half—46.2 per cent—feel the government has fallen short in supporting small businesses and startups. While 29.4 per cent feel flagship schemes such as Make in India and Digital India have made a 'significant' difference, over a quarter (26.7 per cent) report no impact, and 11.9 per cent say the schemes have actually worsened their situation.

Q. How do your current daily expenses compare with those last year?



A majority say daily expenses are difficult to manage, a steady concern over the years

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say